

4) The plugin works with UNIX as well as with Windows.

Installation

The plugin can be built and installed on a GNU/Linux-based system (such as CentOS). Download the plugin file *check_logfiles-3.6.1.tar.gz* and unzip it to a folder. Once you have installed the required software packages, building is simple. Follow the steps given below to start the installation. The plugin has to be installed at both the server and the client side. We have installed CentOS 6.4 at both server and client side. The installation and configuration procedure will work on other Linux distributions as well.

```
[root@nagiosserver]#tar xvfz check_logfiles-3.6.1.tar.gz
[root@nagiosserver]#cd check_logfiles-3.6.1
[root@nagiosserver check_logfiles-3.6.1]#./configure
[root@nagiosserver check_logfiles-3.6.1]#make
[root@nagiosserver check_logfiles-3.6.1]#make install
```

Configuring a service for monitoring

On the server side

Step 1: After installing the *check_logfiles* plugin, change the ownership of *check_logfiles* file to Nagios.

Step 2: For monitoring the log file at the remote client running the SSH server, define the service in `/usr/local/nagios/etc/objects/nagiosclient.cfg` file. In this set-up, I have named the remote Linux client as *nagiosclient*. So I have created the configuration file *nagiosclient.cfg* for the same.

Step 3: Reload the Nagios service.

```
[root@nagiosserver]#service nagios reload
```

Refer to Figure 2 for step-by-step instructions.

On the client side

Step 1: Change the ownership to Nagios for the *check_logfiles* file located in */usr/local/nagios/libexec*.

Step 2: Add the following line to the *nrpe.cfg* file located in */usr/local/nagios/etc*.

```
Command [check_logfiles]=/usr/local/nagios/libexec/check_
logfiles --config /usr/local/nagios/libexec/logs.cfg
```

Step 3: Create the *logs.cfg* file under */usr/local/nagios/libexec* and change the ownership to Nagios and permission (755).

Step 4: Change the group ownership (nagios) and permission ($q+r$) to the log file `/var/log/secure`.

Step 5: Restart the *xinetd* service.

```
[root@nagiosclient]#service xinetd restart
```

Refer to Figure 3 for step-by-step instructions.

We also attempted an SSH login with the wrong password to see the plugin's behaviour.

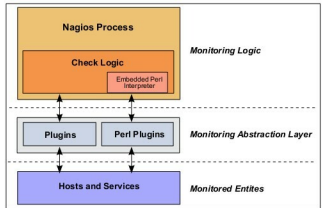


Figure 1: Plugin abstraction layer

[illegible]

Figure 2: Define a service

[illegible]

Figure 3: Client configuration

In this example, I have defined a service, and configured a Linux client to monitor the SSH log file and generate a warning if there are any authentication failures. Similar steps can be followed to configure other such services (Apache, for instance) and log files to be monitored by the Nagios system. I would recommend that you refer to the URLs given below for more insight into the *check_logfiles* plugin. 

References

- [1] <http://www.nagios.org>
- [2] http://labs.consol.de/nagios/check_logfiles/
- [3] <http://exchange.nagios.org/directory/Plugins/Log-Files>
- [4] http://exchange.nagios.org/directory/Plugins/Operating-Systems/Linux/check_logfiles/details

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